

Paolo Di Francesco, PhD

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Senior Solutions Architect at AWS with 15+ years in tech spanning cloud architecture, MLOps, AI/GenAI, cybersecurity, and telecommunications research. Published author, public speaker, and external university lecturer.

Professional Experience

Amazon Web Services (AWS) *Senior Solutions Architect*

Vienna, Austria
Jul 2022 – Present

- Design and implement cloud-based solutions for customers across industries, with focus on MLOps, DevOps, and Generative AI.
- Published 6 technical blog posts on the [AWS Machine Learning Blog](#) (41K+ views), some of which directly influenced the development of new AWS managed services.
- Contributed code to open-source projects including [MLflow](#) (13K+ stars) and the [Amazon SageMaker Python SDK](#) (2K+ stars).
- Developed public workshops used by AWS field teams worldwide and delivered to thousands of customers:
 - [Amazon SageMaker Immersion Day](#) (GitHub)
 - [MLOps: from idea to production in six steps](#) (GitHub)
- Contributed to the launch of a new AWS managed service through technical deep dives with the service team, POCs, and customer onboarding.
- Facilitated multi-day hackathons and innovation events for enterprise customers, with projects going to production.
- Delivered presentations to audiences of 200+ at AWS Summits, Cloud Days, meetups, and university conferences in English, Italian, and German.
- Mentored and onboarded fellow Solutions Architects; contributed to building the local AI/ML community in Austria.

Solutions Architect

2020 – Jul 2022

- Helped customers across startups, SMBs, and enterprises adopt AWS services and design scalable cloud architectures.
- Led cloud migration and adoption programs, including multi-account landing zone setups and cost optimization.
- Delivered immersion days and architecture reviews across industries including manufacturing, media, energy, and technology.

Radarservices GmbH *Software Engineer & Architect*

Vienna, Austria
Oct 2017 – 2020

- Designed and implemented a service-oriented architecture for a cloud-based IT security monitoring product. Led the transformation of a large monolith into a modular, scalable system.
- Defined business processes with enterprise customers and implemented solutions according to their needs.
- Designed and documented REST APIs. Resolved critical performance bottlenecks to meet strict SLAs. Mentored junior developers.

Development Team Leader

Jan 2017 – Oct 2017

- Led a development team ensuring consistent delivery to department standards. Managed hiring and facilitated stakeholder collaboration.

Software Developer

Mar 2016 – Dec 2016

- Implemented features in a test-driven development environment with peer review.

Trinity College Dublin
Postdoctoral Researcher

Dublin, Ireland
Sep 2015 – Mar 2016

- Contributed to the [Fed4FIRE](#) EU FP7 project, developing frontend/backend for remote access to the TCD wireless testbed. Designed a web-based resource management and monitoring system.

Teaching Assistant

Sep 2012 – May 2015

- Taught Java programming and Fundamentals of Electrotechnics (filtering, modulation, oscilloscope usage).

Research Assistant

Mar 2010 – Dec 2010

- Developed a split-architecture for carrier-sensing based MAC protocols on SDR platforms. Collected experimental data to analyse protocol performance in multi-hop wireless networks.

O2 Ireland & Trinity College Dublin
Data Analyst (university-enterprise collaboration)

Dublin, Ireland
Sep 2013 – Sep 2014

- Collected and maintained large datasets of anonymized call detail records. Analysed spatio-temporal dynamics in cellular traffic demand to inform network planning research.

Teaching

TU Wien
External Lecturer – AI and Generative AI module

Vienna, Austria
Mar 2023 – Present

- Lecturing for the [Project Course on Cloud Computing \(192.035\)](#), covering foundation models, prompt engineering, RAG, and building AI-powered applications on the cloud. Multiple cohorts of graduates.

Education

Ph.D. in Electronic & Electrical Engineering Trinity College Dublin, 2011 – 2016
Thesis: “On the Effects of Resource Sharing on Mobile Network Deployment Decisions”
Focus: Algorithm Design, Mathematical Modeling, Linear Optimization, Game Theory, Data Analysis

M.Sc in Telecommunications Engineering University of Bologna, 2008 – 2011

B.Sc in Telecommunications Engineering University of Bologna, 2004 – 2008

Technical Skills

Cloud & AI/ML: Amazon SageMaker AI, Amazon Bedrock, AWS Lambda, Amazon API Gateway, AWS CDK, AWS CloudFormation, Amazon ECS, MLflow, Docker, MLOps

Programming: Python, Java, JavaScript, Ruby, C/C++, MATLAB

Frameworks & Tools: Ruby on Rails, CDK, Git, LaTeX, GNU Radio, Gurobi

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL

Languages

Italian (native) English (fluent) German (basic)

Awards & Certifications

- **Invent & Simplify Award** (2022) – recognized by the AWS Solutions Architecture community for contributions to MLOps and open-source
- Member of the winning team at the **IEEE DySPAN 5G Spectrum Challenge 2015**
- AWS Certified Machine Learning – Specialty (2021) AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional (2021)

Public Speaking

- “FMOps/LLMOps – Managing the Generative AI Lifecycle on AWS” – University of Applied Sciences Burgenland, Mar 2025
- “Accelerate FM pre-training on Amazon SageMaker HyperPod” – AWS Summit Zurich, Sep 2024
- “LLMOps and FMOps – Evaluating and Operating Foundation Models” – AWS Builder Stream, Vienna, Mar 2024
- “Productionize ML workloads using Amazon SageMaker MLOps” – AWS Cloud Day Zurich, Sep 2023
- “Foundation Model Hosting and RAG on AWS” – Vienna Data Science Tools Meetup, Aug 2023
- “MLOps – Automazione per il Machine Learning” – AWS Italy Podcast, Oct 2022

Selected Publications

Journals

- P. Di Francesco et al., “Assembling and Using a Cellular Dataset for Mobile Network Analysis and Planning,” *IEEE Trans. on Big Data*, 4(4), 2018.
- P. Di Francesco et al., “Sensitivity Analysis on Service-Driven Network Planning,” *IEEE/ACM Trans. on Networking*, 25(3), 2017.
- P. Di Francesco et al., “A Sharing- and Competition-Aware Framework for Cellular Network Evolution Planning,” *IEEE Trans. on Cognitive Communications and Networking*, 1(2), 2015.
- P. Di Francesco et al., “A Split MAC Approach for SDR Platforms,” *IEEE Trans. on Computers*, 64(4), 2015.

Conferences

- J. Kibilda, P. Di Francesco et al., “Infrastructure and Spectrum Sharing Trade-offs in Mobile Networks,” *IEEE DySPAN*, 2015.
- P. Di Francesco et al., “Mobile Network Sharing Between Operators: A Demand Trace-Driven Study,” *ACM SIGCOMM CSWS*, 2014.
- A. Puschmann, P. Di Francesco et al., “Enhancing the Performance of Random Access MAC Protocols for Low-cost SDRs,” *ACM WiNTECH*, 2013.
- P. Di Francesco et al., “A Split Architecture for Random Access MAC for SDR Platforms,” *CROWNCOM*, 2013.